Partner With BuilderWars

BuilderWars is the first annual hackathon hosted by the AWS Student Builder Group at Wayne State University. We're bringing together companies invested in Michigan's next generation of software talent for a 24-hour, in-person event at Newlab Detroit on November 14–15, 2026.

100+	24	1st
Total Attendees Expected	Hours of Hacking	Annual BuilderWars

About the Event

Teams of students spend 24 hours designing and building software projects, then pitch their work to a panel of judges. BuilderWars gives students hands-on technical experience while connecting them directly with companies, engineers, and technical leaders shaping Michigan's tech ecosystem.

Why Partner With Us

BuilderWars puts your brand in front of motivated, high-potential student developers at the exact moment they're building their skills and thinking about where to launch their careers. Here's what a partnership gets you:

1. **Early access to talent.** Meet and evaluate motivated student developers and engineers before they hit the job market.
2. **A challenge that's yours.** Sponsor a track built around your industry, tech stack, or a real problem your team wants solved.
3. **Real face time with participants.** Run a workshop, judge projects, mentor teams, or start recruiting conversations on the spot.
4. **Visibility that lasts.** Brand recognition before, during, and after the event across our website, ceremonies, and sponsor communications.

Sponsorship Packages

Sponsorship benefits are designed to give partners visibility and direct access to participants. We are also happy to discuss custom activations that fit your organization.

Tier	Contribution	Benefits
Bronze	$250–999	• Logo on BuilderWars website, merchandise, and sponsor materials • Recognition during opening and closing ceremonies • 2 company representatives invited to attend • Ability to distribute approved company swag/materials • Post-event sponsor recap
Silver	$1,000–1,999	• All Bronze Tier benefits • Recruiting/company table at the event • 4 company representatives invited to attend • Opportunity to host a technical workshop • Dedicated sponsor recognition on social media • Ability to distribute recruiting materials
Gold	$2,000-3,999	• All Silver Tier benefits • Company-sponsored challenge/track* • 5–6 company representatives • Opening ceremony speaking opportunity • Premium company/recruiting table placement • Priority branding across event materials • Opportunity to provide an API, tool, dataset, credits, or other technology for participants • Enhanced post-event engagement summary

Platinum	$4,000+	• All Gold Tier benefits • Highest-priority branding across BuilderWars materials • Featured recognition during opening and closing ceremonies • Up to 8–10 company representatives invited to attend • Priority selection of workshop, speaking, and challenge/track opportunities • Option to sponsor or name a major prize, meal, or participant experience • Expanded premium recruiting presence • Dedicated company spotlight across promotional channels • Custom sponsor activation developed with the BuilderWars organizing team

***Company Track Judging:** *Happens before the main hackathon judging. Only teams that entered the company's sponsored track are eligible. Company representatives evaluate those projects using criteria agreed upon beforehand, select a Track Winner (and optionally a runner-up/honorable mention), and present the award — giving the company direct, meaningful interaction with the students who chose to work with their technology or problem*

In-kind support is welcome. Meals, prizes, technical resources, event services, and other mutually agreed contributions may be credited toward a sponsorship tier at an equivalent value.

Financial donations are processed through Wayne State University and are tax-deductible to the extent permitted by law.

How to Sponsor

Sponsoring BuilderWars takes just a couple of minutes:

1. Visit **giving.wayne.edu/donate**
2. Select “Other” as the designation and enter: **“College of Engineering – Amazon Web Services Student Builder Group at Wayne State University”**
3. Fill in your name, company address, and email, then complete payment

Prefer a walkthrough? See the detailed steps in the AWS_SBG_Donation_Guide.pdf or reach out directly using the contact info below.

Questions? Let's Talk

We'd be glad to discuss a custom partnership that works for your organization.

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